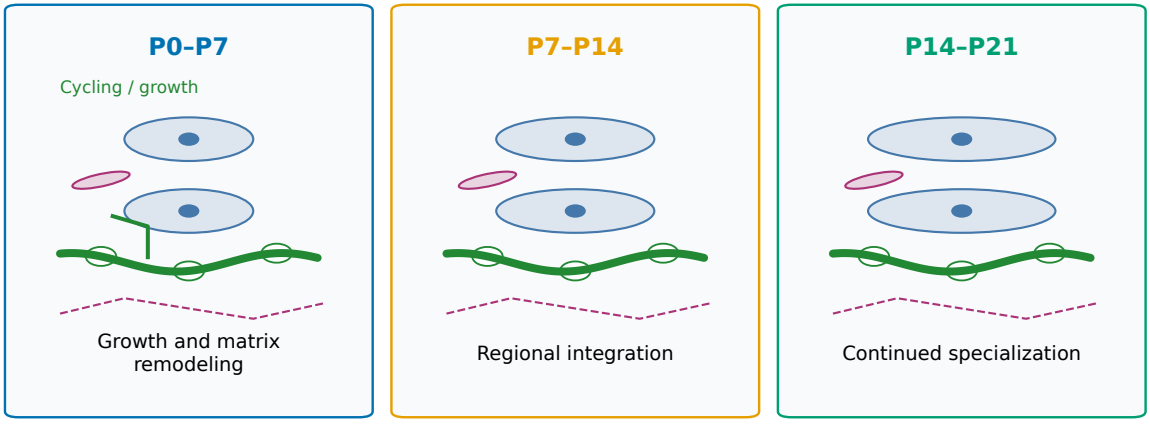
a

Working model · persistent places, changing states



Conceptual tissue units: blue CM; green EC/capillary; purple fibroblast/matrix. Shapes and stages are not morphometric measurements.

b

Anatomy conditions developmental responses

Endocardial interface	Arterial / mural interface	Myocardial interstitium
Persistent Slit2-associated CM context; regional identity is not simply immaturity	Partial Ankrd1 response and Col8a1-associated stromal component	CM–capillary–pericyte neighborhoods with changing fibroblast and vascular states

c

A discriminating experiment · oxygen × EC contact × CM state

Delivery support	Direct contact	CM competence
Measure oxygen and respiration; equal EC number and matrix	Direct versus separated ECs; verify interface and viability	Early versus later starting states; calcium and contractile endpoints

Independent donor preparations are inference units; perturb a candidate receptor only after a contact benefit is demonstrated